

Column

The 64bit architecture has arrived in the smartphone environment, but is it the right move?

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Bazaar

Read to figure out what we have to say about the 20 latest gadgets to hit the market

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Quad-core Tablets

growth in demand of budget or low cost tablets we have seen companies like HCL, Mercury, iberry, Zync, iBall, Karbonn and more enter the market with products that offered a basic Android experience to users at an entry level price.

For this shootout however, we have a set of nine tablets around ₹20,000 – that have a quad-core CPU. The advantage of having a quad-core CPU is that the tablet offers better power management capabilities, faster web page load times, better performance for heavy duty apps, better multitasking and better gaming capabilities when compared to the dual-core offerings in the market. Of course, the processor has to be complimented with adequate RAM, to ensure a smooth and responsive experience.

The tablets that are a part of this shootout showcase the ability to do a lot more than run Facebook and Angry Birds. They act as a portable entertainment device giving users access to movies, music and games on the go. Consumers can also do some productivity work such as documents, spreadsheets and more. They also have access to utility apps, some of which are customized based on your profession such as photo editing, architecture, medical apps

and more. Finally, the most important utility factor of a tablet is that it should have a crisp display for consuming all the content as well as a good touch interface so that you can interact with the device with absolute ease. Not to mention a battery life that has the ability to last for more than a few minutes.

Based on these consumer parameters, we at Digit tested nine tablets available to the consumers today that boast of a quad-core CPU, a 7-inch or larger display and a price tag around ₹20,000. All these devices run on Android.

Design and build

You get what you pay for. That is the general correlation between the price of a tablet and the quality of its build. The plastics used, flex in the display, looks, flashy design and more get better with a higher price tag. This is the general norm and not a rule written in stone. We have seen some budget devices, such as the Zync Quad 8 and the Simmtronics XpadMini showcase some really good build quality.

Starting with the Zync, all the three tablets that came for the shootout are quite similar in their build. The difference of course is with the size of the display and the placement of the ports. The three tablets –

Zync Quad 8, Zync Quad 9.7 and Zync quad 10.1 boast of an 8-inch, 9.7-inch and 10.1-inch display respectively. The front of the Zync Quad 8 has a white border around the screen very reminiscent of the white iPad. The rear on the other hand has a gunmetal finish.

The build of the Quad 8 is really good considering the price point. The tablet has a proprietary charging port and the micro USB port is used only for data transfer. The tablet also supports a mini HDMI out.

Coming to the Quad 9.7 and the quad 10.1, they are quite identical in their design and build. The 9.7-inch tablet has a square design and the 10.1-inch tablet is more rectangular. The resolution of the two tablets too is different. Both the devices have a black border around the display and the rear has a gunmetal finish. Their connectivity options too are the same.

Moving on, we have the iberry Auxus Core X4 3G tablet that has a 9.7-inch display. The tablet is the heaviest in this shootout. The rear has a metal finish with plastic on either side (when held in landscape mode). The SIM card slot and the microSD card slot rest under a cover and that is good as it protects the cards. The tablet has a black matte finish which is nice.

The first thing that you will notice when you see the Simmtronics XPAD Mini is that it looks a lot like the iPad mini in its form factor. The tablet has a 7.85-inch display and the rear of the tablet has a gunmetal finish. The tablet supports HDMI out and the design of the tablet is surprisingly comfortable to use. We have seen 7-inch and 10-inch tablets and have adapted ourselves to the format. The 8-inch Zinc Quad 8 was a refreshing change and the same can be said about the



Zync Quad 8

XPAD Mini. It is easy to type with two thumbs in portrait mode but it is landscape where things might take some getting used to. The tablet has a nice slim form factor too.

The Huawei MediaPad 10 Link is quite slim but it isn't the lightest tablet of this shootout. The rear of the tablet has a dual-tone colour, silver and white, with a metal and plastic finish. The rear also has the camera without a flash. The MediaPad 10 Link has a plastic finish with the curvy edges, which makes it comfortable to hold. The rear of the Huawei MediaPad 10 Link houses two speakers and when held in landscape mode, and they are well positioned so that your hands do not cover them.

The Ceros revolution tablet has a build very reminiscent of the iberry CoreX4 3G tablet. The rear is black matte and plain, without any textured finish. There is a physical back button along with the power button but no physical volume rocker. The volume can be controlled only from the touchscreen.

Last but not least, we have both, the first and the second-generation Nexus 7 tablets. Starting with the first generation Nexus, the tablet has a compact and slim profile and only a microUSB port as the connectivity option. There is no rear-facing camera and it

Huawei
Mediapad 10

